TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

Faculty of Automatic Control and Computer Science

Lecturer Simona Mazilu, PhD

Course Requirements

- 7 courses
- 7 seminars

10 % course attendance

20% seminar activity

40 % midterm evaluation (written hw + interview)

30 % final evaluation (written hw + oral presentation)

Core Values

- Honesty
- Respect
- Care

Course content

Technical Communication:

- "A generic term for all written and oral communication done on the job - whether in business, industry, or in other settings". (Pfeiffer and Adkins 2012: 2)
- "The *process* of making and sharing information and ideas in the workplace, and as a set of *applications* - the documents you write". (Markel 2012: 4)

Course Content

- Ex. of technical communication: e-mails, memos, sales letters, reports, manuals, presentations, press releases, research projects, proposals, technical/scientific articles/abstracts/summaries etc.
- Criteria of excellence for evaluating technical communication: “honesty, clarity, accuracy, comprehensiveness, accessibility, conciseness, professional appearance, and correctness”. (Markel 2012: 12)

Course Content

1) **Getting a job**: elements of the employment file: CV writing/ Cover letter/ Interview in the IT profession
2) **Maintaining a job**: Technical documents (characteristics of technical writing)/ Technical presentations/ Workplace interpersonal skills for engineers

Course Rationale

- “Communication skills are a threshold skill required to get and keep a job”. (Markel 2012: 6)
- Academic environment should equip engineering students with both hard and soft skills in order to prepare them for the workplace.

Course Objectives

- To help engineering students develop oral and written technical communication skills related to applying for and maintaining a job.
- To enable engineering students to gain insight into the workplace dynamics.

Student Course Map

- **Communication within the job application process**: self-analysis (strengths/weaknesses; extrovert/introvert) > finding an appropriate job/internship > applying for it (CV, CL) > attending a job interview
- **Communication at the workplace**: developing workplace interpersonal skills > perfecting presentation skills

To do for Seminar 1

- Find a job/ internship ad you consider suitable for your current IT competences/ skills and you would like to apply for.
- Write down your key competences/skills, your personal qualities and your weaknesses related to the job/internship you found.

References

- Markel, M. (2012). *Technical Communication*. Boston/New York: Bedford/St. Martin’s.
- Pfeiffer, W. S. and Adkins, K. E. (2012). *Technical Communication Fundamentals*. New Jersey: Prentice Hall.